



**Flemish kirtle** All women wore tight-fitting kirtles. This one, from around 1435, is made from squirrel skins with the fur turned inside, seen at the hem. Long, red wool outer sleeves pin on to the short kirtle sleeves. The skirt attaches at the waist, a new construction method.

Linen shift visible at neckline

Tablet-woven silk belt

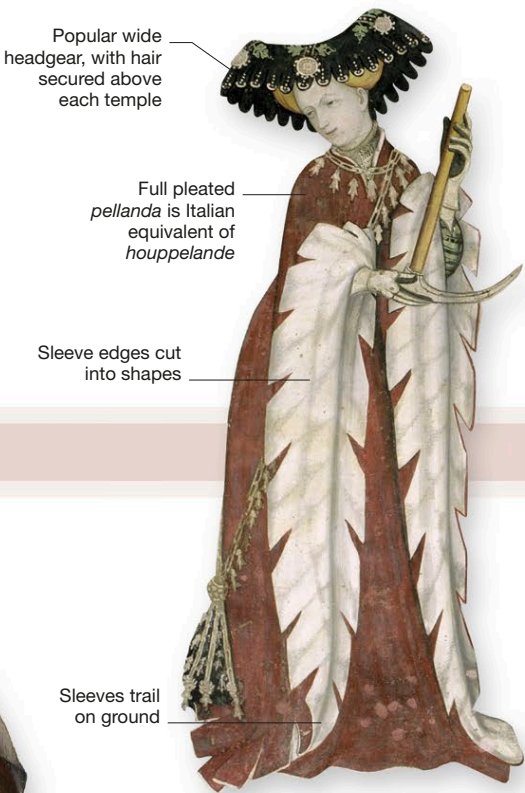


Cloth-of-gold kirtle

Hair plaited under linen veil with frilled selvages

High girde is tablet-woven in silk, with gold ends

Plentiful fabric in gown skirt



Popular wide headgear, with hair secured above each temple

Full pleated pellanda is Italian equivalent of houppelande

Sleeve edges cut into shapes

Sleeves trail on ground

**Piedmontese noble** This northern Italian allegorical figure wears a huge, cut-sleeved pellanda with fur lining over symbolic armour. A chain with leaf pendants is draped around her. Her hat is cut, pearled, and embroidered.



Large fur hat with feathers

Modest-sized sleeves

High, round bust

Long sash of imported coral beads fabulously costly

Golden cote underneath

Houppelande with ground-length trails

**Height of fashion** A noble French betrothal in the 1410s was an excuse for the finest clothing. This bride's houppe is made of expensive, Italian-made, gold patterned silk.